

GIVING OPINION

STATING AN OPINION
ASKING FOR AN OPINION



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INTRODUCTION

Opinion is a judgment made on an individual, a living being, a phenomenon, a fact, an object or a thing. It can be considered good or bad. Opinion can influence and can give good or bad information on a subject studied within a group, a person, an object. An opinion is a set of judgments made about an object. Opinion is the conception that persuasion can shake; fluctuation of thought by speech. Thought that speech can lead to false as well as true. An opinion is a statement about what to do. Opinions can be paradoxical, consensual or questionable.

I. STATING AN OPINION

A. How to Give an Opinion

We share our opinions and ideas every day at work and with friends and family. Therefore, it is very important that we are able to do this fluently in English. In this Lesson, we will cover the most common ways to give an opinion in English.

- The most common way to give an opinion is to use the verb **"to think".**

I think that + statement

After "**that**" we need to put a new sentence with a subject and a verb.

Example:
I think that the restaurant is good.
If there is no subject or no verb after "**I think that**", then the sentence is wrong.

ATTENTION! ~~I think that the painting beautiful~~. I think that the painting is beautiful.

- We can also use the verbs **"Feel"** and **"Believe"** to express an opinion**.** The sentence pattern is the same as **"Think".**

I feel that + statement, I believe that + statement

Example:
I **believe that** we should invest more in research and development.
I **feel that** this plan is not a good idea.

- These sentences have a very similar meaning to sentences with "**Think**", but they give a different feeling. "**Feel**" and "**Believe**" are stronger than

"**think**" and they show that they are relying more on belief and feeling instead of logic and reason. I believe that she is alive. I believe that I can do anything. I feel that she will betray us. I don't know why I think this. I just feel It.

Sometimes, it is a little strange to use "**Feel**" or "**Believe**". They are too strong and do not fit the situation.

Example:
I **feel** that popcorn is delicious.
I **Believe** that action movies are fun.

For both of the sentences above, it is much better to use "**I think**..."

- We can make negative sentences to show what we do not think, feel, or believe. We just need to add "**Do not**" before the verb "**Think**", "**Feel**", or "**Believe**".

Example:
I don't **think** that it will rain tomorrow.
I do not **believe** that we can win.

- We can do the same thing by using the word "**not**" in the second part.

Example:
I **think** that she is not nice. (=I don't **think** that she is nice.)
I **believe** that aliens do not exist. (=I don't **believe** that aliens exist.)

Remember that our opinion can be in any tense. It depends on the situation. I think that she is nice. I think that she was nice. I think that she will be nice. I think that she is being nice. I think that she has been nice.

- We can also use the past tense of "**Think**", "**Feel**", or "**Believe**" to talk about our opinions in the past. These are things that we do not think now.

Example :
I **thought** that video games were fun when I was young, but now I think that video games are boring.
I **felt** that she was not nice the first time I met her, but now I think that she is great.
I **believe** that Santa Claus was real when I was in elementary school, but now I know that he is not real.

- The word "**that**" is optional in all of these sentences. We can take it out if we want too. It is the speaker or writer's choice.

Example :
I **think** she is pretty. (=I **think** that she is pretty.)
I **think** using electric cars is the best way to fight air pollution.
(=I **think** that using electric cars is the best way to fight air pollution.)
I don't feel she was trying her best. (=I don't **feel** that she was trying her best.)

Sometimes we use a phrase at the beginning of the sentence to tell the listener that this is our opinion. Here are the most common ones.

In my opinion, + statemen

Example:
In my opinion we must look for the solution for this problem.
In my opinion the president must change the way he is governed.

In my view, + statement

Example:
In my view, she is an effective leader.
In my view, we need to spend more time planning.

From my perspective, + statement

Example:
From my perspective, their relationship is failing because they do not communicate well with each other.
From my perspective, our strategy is not working.

This next expression is quite strong and we only use it when making a serious point.

As far as I am concerned, + statement

Example:
As far as I am concerned, this project is dead until we get more funding.
As far as I am concerned, there is nothing to talk about.

- There are other expressions and sentence patterns that we can use to express an opinion. The ones we covered above in this lesson are the most common ways. But here are a few other ways that we could express an opinion

Example:

In my experience, it was great.

The way I see it is that our manager needs to communicate more honestly with the staff.

Personally, I think that it4 is not great.

B. TYPES OF OPINION

1. GENERAL OPINION

Opinion being a judgment (which is made on an individual, a living being, a fact, an object, a phenomenon, etc.), what is called public opinion designates all convictions and belief more or less shared by the population of given society.

Example:
We say than Afrique is the best restaurant.
Everyone know than the life is very hard on the Campus.

2. PERSONAL OPINION

We speak of "personal opinion" when it is expressed individuality and of a "Public opinion" or "Popular "when it is carried collectively by society or presented as such.

Example:
In my view we will all validate the "License 1".
For me it's the better

3. OPINION CAN BE PARADOXICAL

Opinion contrary to commonly held views: Support paradoxes. ... Being, thing or fact which seem to defy logic because they present contradictory aspects: This victory of the weakest, it is a paradox.

4. OPINION CAN BE QUESTIONNABLE

Human beings, because they have the capacity to think, therefore have the possibility of forming an opinion about everything. He thus has the ability to express an opinion on a subject, believing a priori that his judgment is true. With all his opinions, he therefore has a set of beliefs, philosophical, religious and political convictions. However, unlike science which is taken to be a correct truth, opinion is questionable. And this discussion is made

possible thanks to the human rights established in a democracy and advocating respect for the opinions of others, which amounts to putting them in the same relationship of equality in value.

Example:

Today I think Samsung is the best phone brand in the world.

The richest man in the world is Machy.

5. OPINION CAN BE CONSENSUAL

Agreement and consent of the greatest number of public opinions, social consensus. Procedure which consists in reaching an agreement without proceeding to a formal vote with avoids revealing objections and abstentions.

Example:

Life in the Campus is very hard.

II. ASKING FOR AN OPINION

A. HOW TO ASK FOR AN OPINION

We need to be able to ask what other people think if we want to have natural English conversations and if we want to communicate effectively.

In this lesson, we will cover the most common ways to ask for another person's opinion in English.

- Here is the most common question. This question just asks for a person's general opinion about something.

What do you think about + noun?

Example:

What do you think about this restaurant?

What do you think about nuclear energy?

- We can also use this pattern. This pattern can be used the same as **"What do you think..."**

How do you feel about + noun?

Example:

How do you feel about your new job?

Again, we can also use a gerund or a noun clause instead of a noun.

Example:
How do you feel about donating money to charity?
How do you feel about spending money on space travel?

- **We can use yes/no questions to ask a more specific question.**

Example:
Do you think that our country should build more nuclear power plants?
Do you feel that people worry too much about the future?

Also, we can ask about past opinions.

Example:
Did you think that the movie was romantic?
Did you think that she liked me?

- **We can also use short questions to ask a person's opinion when the person already knows the topic. Here are the questions that we usually use.**

Example:
What do you think about that?
What is your opinion about that?

B. WHY ASKING FOR AN OPINION?

You can ask for an opinion to validate or reject a thesis. Adopting this attitude allows us to avoid certain confusion. Indeed, the opinion is a verification test.

1. ASKING FOR ADVICE

there are several ways to give advice in English:

> we can use a modal verb

There are two modal verbs frequently used to give advice: 'should' and 'ought to'. Each means the same thing, but works in a slightly different way.

Exemple:

You should do more exercise.

You ought to do more exercise.

You ought not to drink so much beer.

Unlike ‘should’, to ’is always used in ‘ought to ’to give advice.

To give less direct advice, a question can be used.

Exemple:

Why don’t you do some more exercise?

How about doing some more exercise?

Thanks to the question "Why don’t you ...?" We use an infinitive without "to". When using ‘How about…? ‘to formulate a question, it is followed by a gerund.

we can put ourselves in the person's shoes

If someone asks us for advice, sometimes it helps to imagine yourself in that person's shoes.

Exemple:

If I were you, I would do more exercise.

use an infinitive after 'would', not 'to'. To make it negative, add "not" after "would".

A suggestion or recommendation is another great way to give advice without being blunt. the words 'suggest' or 'recommend' can be used

Exemple:

I would suggest doing more exercise.

I recommend you to exercise more.

you can use an verb + ing ’after suggest’ or recommend ’to explain your advice to the person. To turn them into negations, we can add "not" before "verb + ing".

we can also advise with more force

Sometimes it just happens to let the person know that this is really important. We can then use the expression 'you had better ...' to achieve this.

Exemple:

You had better do more exercise before you start getting fat.

You had better not drink so much beer or you will get fat.

We use an infinitive after 'better' to explain a tip, and we add 'not' after better 'to make it a negative?

2. TO HAVE CERTAINTY

We can express our opinion to express certainty, the fact of having no doubts, of being convinced, there are many words and expressions in English.

- It goes without saying (that)…
- I could swear that…
- He is certain / sure to refuse…
- I have my doubts about it!
- Nobody doubts that…/ There can be no doubt that…
- I cannot say for certain / for sure…
- I couldn't believe my eyes / my ears…

Exemple:

I'm really doubtful about that decision I have to make now… can you give me your opinion and help?

Really when I heard the horrors Manga said about Diop I couldn't believe my ears; they were all lies.

III. DIALOGUE

TOPIC: Food poisoning can cause death in some situations.

Lewis: In my opinion his death has nothing to do with food poisoning.

Pape: I think his death was due to food poisoning.

Lewis: Do you have tangible proof?

Pape: No, but I believe he was not sick before the poisoning

Lewis: From my point of view, we cannot move forward on this matter

Pape: So, let's hear the doctor's opinion

Doctor: Generally speaking, I cannot close this case. I suggest you do an autopsy

Lewis: I believe this won't last

Doctor: No.

Lewis: Thank you doctor